

Autonomous Authority Standard (AAS)

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Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture (ASGA™)

Operational Layer: Autonomous Operational Governance Layer

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Autonomous Operational Governance

Type: Parent Standard

Governed Space: Autonomous Operational Authority

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Standard

Origin Date: 4 July 2026

Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Governance Architecture (GOA™) · Operational Reality Architecture (ORA™) · Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™) · AI Governance Architecture (AIG®) · Cognitive Governance Intelligence Architecture (CLIA®) · Memory Governance Intelligence Architecture (MGIA™)

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Governed Space

Autonomous Operational Authority

Core Question

Who has authority to perform autonomous operations?

Canonical Definition

Autonomous Authority Standard (AAS) defines the structural conditions under which autonomous operational authority is established, assigned, delegated, validated, restricted, and revoked while preserving governance legitimacy, operational accountability, and controlled autonomous execution throughout the complete autonomous operational lifecycle.

AAS governs autonomous operational authority.

The standard establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that every autonomous operation is performed only under legitimate, verifiable, and governance-approved operational authority.

Identity establishes who the autonomous actor is.

Authority establishes what the autonomous actor is permitted to do.

AAS governs that authority.

Governance Flow Position

Autonomous Identity → Autonomous Authority → Autonomous Execution → Autonomous Constraints → Autonomous Risk & Trust → Autonomous Coordination → Autonomous Escalation → Autonomous Operational Accountability → Autonomous Compatibility → Autonomous Evolution

Standard Abstract

Autonomous systems may possess advanced capabilities, but capability alone does not authorize autonomous action.

Before an autonomous system performs independent operations, operational authority must first be established.

Without governed authority:

- autonomous actions lack legitimacy,
- permissions become ambiguous,
- operational accountability weakens,
- governance boundaries become difficult to enforce,
- autonomous ecosystems become less trustworthy.

AAS establishes the governance foundation that determines when, where, how, and under which conditions autonomous authority may exist.

Operational Role

Autonomous Authority Standard provides the governance layer responsible for establishing, controlling, validating, restricting, delegating, and revoking autonomous operational authority.

Its role is to ensure that autonomous authority remains legitimate, controlled, and continuously governable throughout autonomous operation.

Operational Space

AAS governs:

- autonomous operational authority,
 - authority assignment,
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- authority delegation,
- authority validation,
- authority restriction,
- authority revocation,
- operational permissions,
- governance-approved autonomous authority.

This governed space ensures that autonomous authority is always explicitly established before autonomous execution begins.

Why This Standard Exists

Autonomous systems increasingly perform operations without continuous human intervention.

As autonomy expands, operational authority becomes a governance requirement rather than a purely technical configuration.

Without governed authority:

- autonomous systems may exceed intended permissions,
- authority becomes difficult to verify,
- operational legitimacy declines,
- governance loses effective control over autonomous execution.

AAS exists because autonomous operational authority is the second governable space of Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture (ASGA™).

Scope

This standard may be applied across:

- autonomous AI agents,
 - robotics,
 - industrial automation,
 - autonomous vehicles,
 - healthcare autonomous systems,
 - enterprise AI platforms,
 - critical infrastructure,
 - defense autonomy,
 - Human-AI operational environments,
 - multi-agent ecosystems.
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Relationship to Other OOF® Architectures

AAS governs autonomous operational authority.

It interoperates with:

- **GOA™** for governance authority,
- **AGA™** for accountability,
- **AIG®** for AI behavioral governance,
- **ORA™** for operational reality,
- **CLIA®** for cognition,
- **MGIA™** for memory governance.

Together these architectures establish the governance conditions required for legitimate and trustworthy autonomous operation.

Foundational Principle

Autonomous capability does not create autonomous authority. Legitimate autonomous operation begins only when operational authority has been explicitly established, governed, and continuously validated.

Canonical Closing Statement

Autonomous Authority establishes the governance conditions under which autonomous systems may legitimately perform independent operations. By governing operational authority before autonomous execution begins, AAS strengthens accountability, operational legitimacy, and trustworthy autonomy throughout the complete autonomous operational lifecycle.

Module Architecture

→ Operational Authority Assignment Module (OAAM)

→ Operational Authority Delegation Module (OADM)

→ Operational Authority Validation Module (OAVM)

→ Operational Authority Restriction Module (OARM)

→ Operational Authority Revocation Module (OARM)

Related Documents

→ About Autonomous Authority Standard (AAS)

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Canonical Source

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